

Enhancing accountability and effectiveness in project management

# MODULE 8 : MONITORING, EVALUATION & REPORTING AND GRIEVANCE REDRESS (MERG)



# OPENING AND CONTEXT



## PURPOSE

### **Monitoring, Evaluation & Reporting (MER)**

Introduces the GCF requirements for monitoring, evaluation, and reporting to support effective project oversight, learning, and accountability.

### **Grievance Redress Mechanism (GRM)**

Explains the institutional requirements for establishing accessible and effective mechanisms to receive and address project-related grievances.

### **Accreditation Readiness**

Strengthens institutional understanding of MER and GRM requirements to support GCF accreditation, transparency and responsible project implementation.



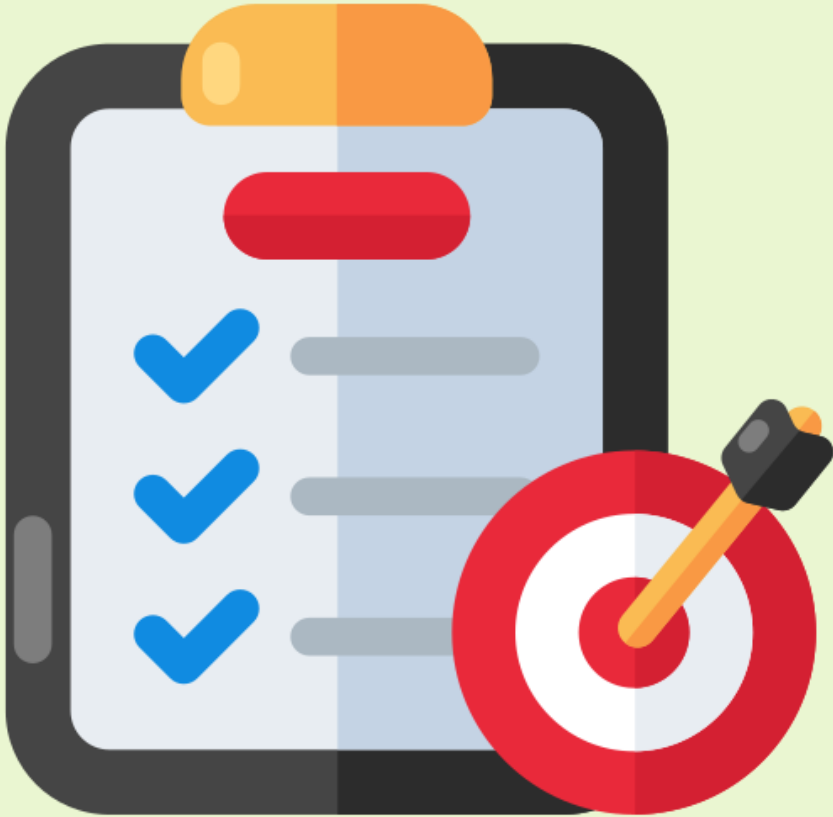
## SCOPE

### Focus on M&E and Grievance Redress Systems

The session focuses on Monitoring, Evaluation & Reporting and the Grievance Redress Mechanism within GCF accreditation requirements.

### Practical Systems and Documentation Requirements

It covers the institutional systems, documentation and processes needed to demonstrate readiness and compliance with GCF fiduciary standards.



## OBJECTIVES

### **Understanding GCF M&E and GRM Requirements**

Learn key Monitoring, Evaluation & Reporting and Grievance Redress requirements at the accreditation stage.

### **Results-Based Management Concepts**

Understand basic results chain concepts, including inputs, activities, outputs, outcomes, and impact.

### **Grievance Redress Mechanism Requirements**

Identify essential features of effective grievance mechanisms, including accessibility, procedures, and responsiveness.

### **Self-Assessment for Readiness**

Assess institutional MER and GRM systems to identify gaps and improve accreditation readiness.



# WHY MONITORING, EVALUATION & REPORTING MATTERS FOR ACCREDITATION



## Critical Role of MER

Effective Monitoring, Evaluation & Reporting ensures confidence in tracking project results, especially climate impacts.

## Institutional Level Assessment

MER systems are evaluated institutionally during accreditation.

## Results-Based Reporting

Reporting focuses on outputs, outcomes, and impacts rather than just activities or expenditures.

## Strategic Value of MER

MER supports adaptive management and evidence-based decisions, not merely compliance.



## WHY GRIEVANCE REDRESS MATTERS FOR ACCREDITATION



### **Mandatory GRM Requirement**

Grievance Redress Mechanisms are mandatory for entities under the GCF accreditation to ensure accountability and transparency.

### **Function of GRM**

A functioning GRM shows commitment to listening to stakeholders and managing social and environmental risks effectively.

### **Risks of Weak GRM**

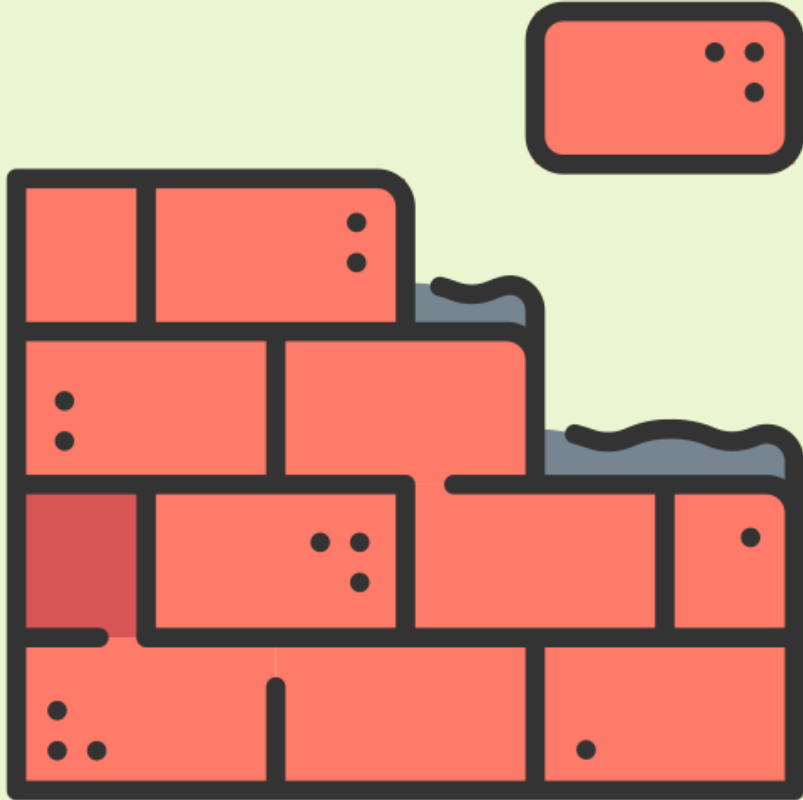
A missing or weak GRM is a serious deficiency leading to negative accreditation outcomes and governance risks.

### **GRM as Governance Tool**

GRM is a core governance and risk management tool, requiring practical, well-embedded systems beyond formalities.



# MONITORING, EVALUATION & REPORTING



## MER FUNDAMENTALS

### Purpose of MER

MER tracks project progress toward goals, supports improvement, ensures accountability, and enables reporting and learning.

### Monitoring vs Evaluation

Monitoring is continuous data collection; evaluation assesses effectiveness and impact over time.

### Reporting

Reporting communicates results, progress, and compliance to stakeholders and donors (e.g., GCF).

### Internal Management System

MER is an internal decision-making tool, not only a donor reporting requirement.

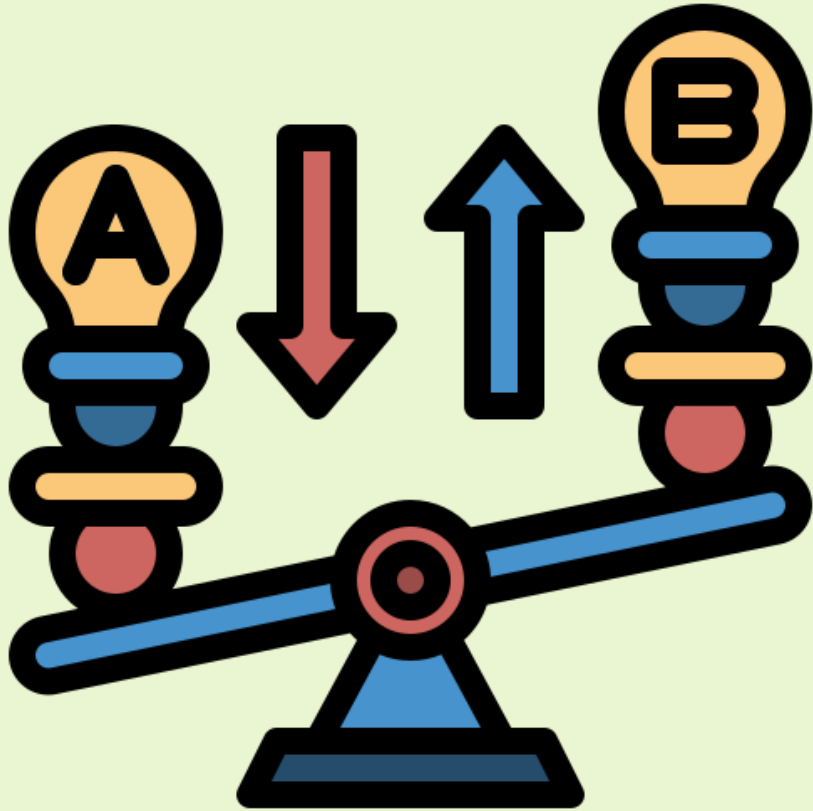
### Plain Language Benefits

Simple language improves understanding and encourages broader ownership beyond specialists.



## THE RESULTS CHAIN - INPUTS TO IMPACT

| Level             | Definition                                             | Example                                                |
|-------------------|--------------------------------------------------------|--------------------------------------------------------|
| <b>Inputs</b>     | Financial, human, and material resources               | \$5 million budget, 10 project staff                   |
| <b>Activities</b> | Actions carried out to implement the project           | Training 500 farmers, installing 200 MW solar          |
| <b>Outputs</b>    | Direct deliverables produced by activities             | 200 MW installed, 50,000 ha restored                   |
| <b>Outcomes</b>   | Medium-term changes resulting from outputs             | Reduced emissions, improved resilience                 |
| <b>Impact</b>     | Long-term, broader development or climate contribution | Contribution to national NDC targets and climate goals |



## BEST BALANCED OPTION

### Focus on Outputs, Outcomes, Impact

GCF prioritizes outputs, outcomes, and impact to measure real, meaningful climate finance changes.

### Measurable Indicators with Baselines

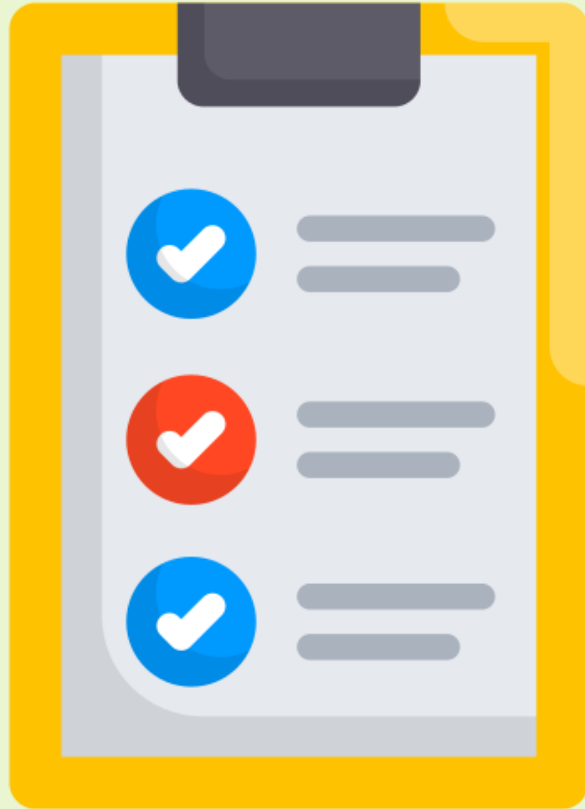
Clear baselines and targets for indicators ensure objective progress tracking over time.

### Results Over Activities

GCF emphasizes behavioral or practice changes rather than just counting activities like training sessions.

### Aligning MER Systems

Understanding GCF priorities helps improve MER systems and strengthen reporting credibility.



## MER REQUIREMENTS FOR ACCREDITATION

### Formal MER Systems

Entities must have formal MER policies, manuals, and data collection systems established prior to accreditation.

### Defined Roles and Templates

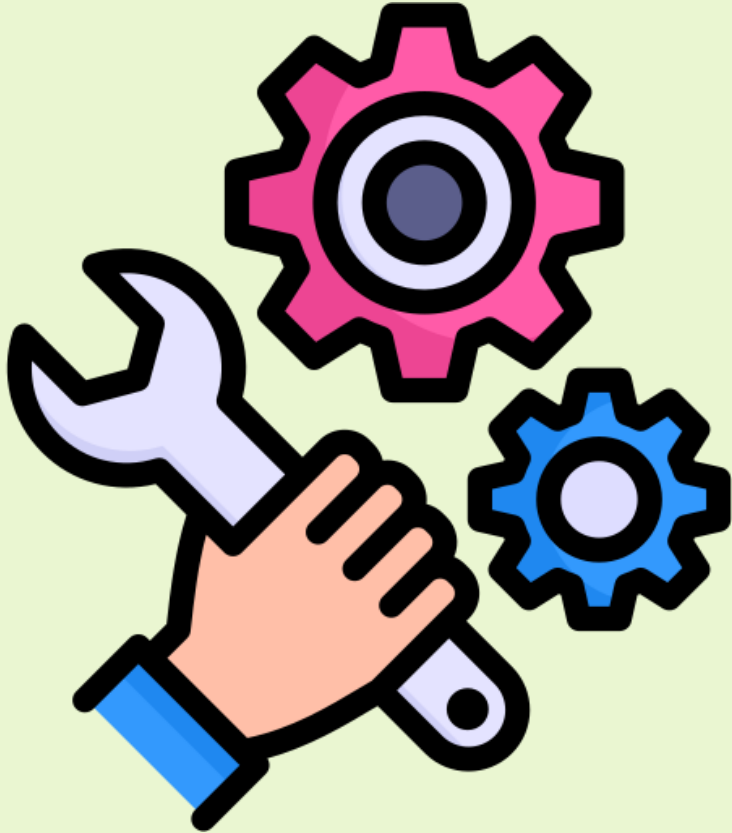
Clear roles, responsibilities, and standardized reporting templates (narrative, financial, and results-based) are required.

### Proven Reporting Experience

Prior experience producing donor reports demonstrates practical capacity beyond theoretical readiness.

### Institutional Accountability

GCF assesses documented processes, accountability assignments, and evidence of MER system use.



## CORE COMPONENTS OF A MER SYSTEM

### **M&E Framework**

Policies and procedures guide consistent monitoring and evaluation activities.

### **Results Framework**

Indicators, baselines, and targets measure progress and results.

### **Data Collection and Management**

Standardized tools and systems support reliable data collection, storage, and analysis.

### **Reporting Arrangements**

Templates, schedules, and responsibilities ensure timely and consistent reporting.

### **Use of Findings**

Monitoring and evaluation results inform decision-making, learning, and continuous improvement.



## MER POLICY AND SUPPORTING COMPONENTS

| Component           | What It Means                      | Evidence                   |
|---------------------|------------------------------------|----------------------------|
| Indicator framework | What you measure, baseline, target | M&E plan from past project |
| Data collection     | How data is gathered               | Data collection templates  |
| Data management     | Where data is stored               | Sample data files          |
| Reporting templates | How you report                     | Past progress reports      |
| Use of data         | Decision-making                    | Meeting minutes            |



# GRIEVANCE REDRESS MECHANISM



# UNDERSTANDING THE GRIEVANCE REDRESS MECHANISMS

## Definition of GRM

A Grievance Redress Mechanism is a formal process enabling affected people to raise concerns and receive timely responses.

## Formality and Structure

GRM requires structured, documented, and consistent application rather than informal or ad hoc handling.

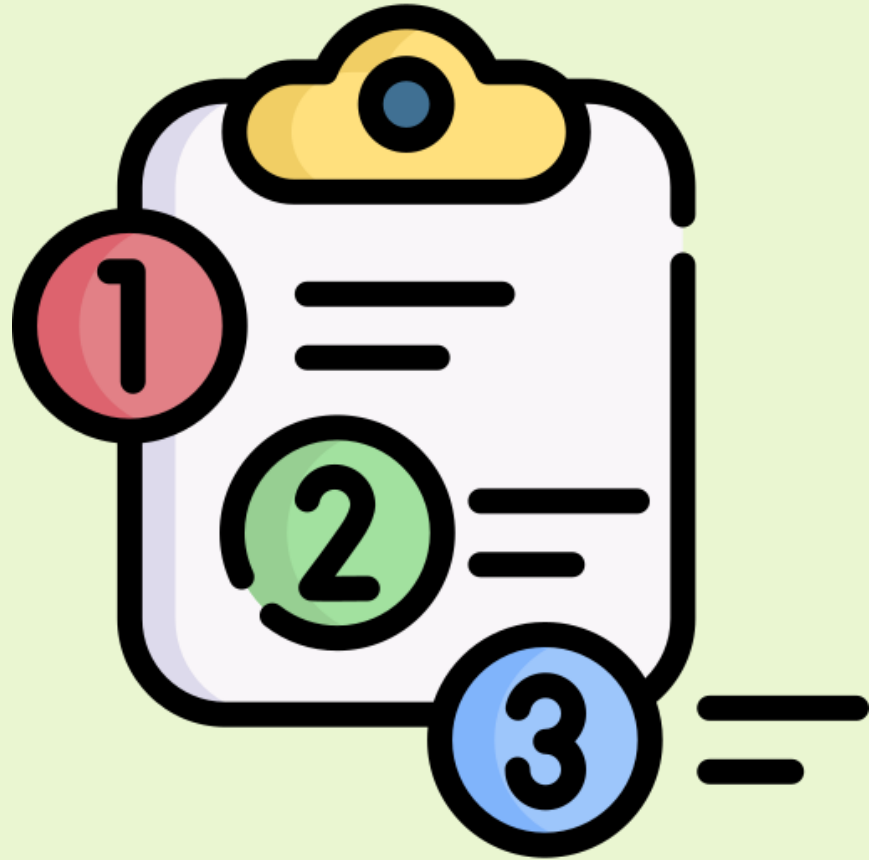
## Role in Risk Management

GRM supports risk management, social accountability, and stakeholder engagement by preventing conflict escalation and identifying impacts.

## Building Trust

Effective GRM maintains trust with communities by addressing issues fairly and transparently.





## GRM REQUIREMENTS AT ACCREDITATION

### Written GRM document

A documented GRM procedure or mechanism is essential to ensure clear guidance, accessibility, and consistent handling of grievances throughout project implementation and accreditation requirements.

### Defined Process Steps

Clear steps for intake, acknowledgment, investigation, resolution, and appeals ensure transparency and systematic complaint handling.

### Designated GRM Focal Point

A responsible individual or team must be designated to implement and oversee the GRM effectively.

### Timelines and Tracking

Defined timelines and a complaint logging system are crucial to monitor progress and operational readiness.



## THE FIVE STEPS OF A GRIEVANCE REDRESS MECHANISM

| Step                             | Description                                                  | Indicative Timeline                         |
|----------------------------------|--------------------------------------------------------------|---------------------------------------------|
| <b>Intake &amp; Registration</b> | Complaint received and recorded in grievance log             | Day 0                                       |
| <b>Acknowledgement</b>           | Confirmation of receipt provided to complainant              | Within 5-7 working days                     |
| <b>Investigation</b>             | Case reviewed, facts collected, and classification completed | 5-20 working days (depending on complexity) |
| <b>Resolution &amp; Feedback</b> | Decision taken and corrective action implemented             | Up to ~30 working days (flexible by case)   |
| <b>Appeals / Escalation</b>      | Opportunity for complainant to escalate if not satisfied     | As defined by GRM procedure                 |



## GRM ACCESSIBILITY REQUIREMENTS

### **Inclusive Access for All**

GRM must be accessible to all, including women, illiterate people, and remote communities to ensure no one is excluded.

### **Multiple Intake Channels**

Providing in-person, phone, written, and online channels removes barriers and improves accessibility of the GRM.

### **Confidentiality and Protection**

The GRM must protect confidentiality and prevent retaliation to build trust and encourage use by affected people.

### **Free and Local Language Support**

GRM services should be free of charge and available in local languages to maximize usability and inclusivity.



## COMMON GRM GAPS IDENTIFIED DURING ACCREDITATION

### **Absence of GRM Policy**

Many assessments revealed the lack of a formal, written grievance redress mechanism procedure within organizations.

### **Lack of Awareness**

Affected communities often are unaware of the GRM, limiting their ability to raise grievances effectively.

### **No Designated Focal Point**

Organizations frequently miss assigning a specific contact person responsible for grievance management.

### **Missing Response Timelines and Tracking**

The lack of defined response timelines and complaint tracking systems hampers grievance resolution efficiency.

### **No Appeals or Escalation Pathway**

Frequently, complainants are not informed about their rights to appeal or escalate issues to independent redress mechanisms.



## GRM DOCUMENTATION AND EVIDENCE

### GRM Procedures

Documented GRM procedures, complaint forms, and complaint registers demonstrate established processes.

### Designated Responsibilities

A designated GRM focal point ensures effective complaint handling and communication.

### Stakeholder Awareness

Outreach materials show how affected communities are informed about the GRM.

### Evidence of Implementation

Anonymized examples of resolved complaints demonstrate that the mechanism is operational and effective.



# SELF-ASSESSMENT & GAPS



## ENTITY SELF-ASSESSMENT - REM



### Structured MER Checklist

The checklist prompts entities to evaluate presence of MER policy, indicators, and data tools systematically.

### Data Collection and Storage

Highlights importance of using effective data collection tools and reliable storage systems for accurate M&E.

### Use of MER Data in Management

Shows how MER data supports management decisions and promotes evidence-based improvements.

### Proactive Self-Assessment Approach

Encourages honest reflection to identify strengths and weaknesses before accreditation processes.



## ENTITY SELF-ASSESSMENT - GRM



### **Written GRM procedure/mechanism**

Having a documented grievance redress mechanism policy ensures clarity and formal guidance for entities.

### **Defined GRM Process**

A clear five-step grievance process provides a structured approach to handling complaints effectively.

### **Designated Focal Point**

Assigning a focal point centralizes responsibility, improving accountability and grievance management.

### **Community Outreach and Records**

Engaging communities and maintaining complaint logs enhance transparency and help identify unseen gaps.



## COMMON GAPS IN M&E AND GRM



### Monitoring & Evaluation Gaps

Common issues include missing M&E policies and indicators without clear baselines or targets, weakening project assessment.

### Data Management Weaknesses

Weak data management systems compromise the accuracy and reliability of project monitoring and reporting.

### GRM Procedure Deficiencies

Absence or underuse of grievances redress mechanisms, lack of complaint logs, and poor community engagement reduce accountability.



# ROADMAP AND KEY TAKEAWAYS



## PATHWAY TO STRENGTHENING GOVERNANCE



### Short-Term Actions

Review MER and GRM systems, identify gaps, and establish or update key frameworks, procedures, and tools.

### Medium-Term Actions

Implement MER indicators, data systems, reporting arrangements, and operationalize GRM processes and focal points.

### Long-Term Actions

Strengthen system maturity through consistent application, periodic reviews, and integration of M&E and GRM across projects and decision-making.



## KEY TAKEAWAYS ON ERM AND GRM



### Monitoring and Evaluation Systems

GCF requires robust M&E systems documenting outputs, outcomes, and impact beyond just activities.

### Grievance Redress Mechanism (GRM)

GRM is mandatory for most entities and involves five procedural steps with accessibility features.

### Importance of Evidence

Documented policies, templates, reports, and logs provide strong evidence to support M&E and GRM.

### Self-Assessment and Gap Analysis

Self-assessment and gap analysis are essential steps to prepare and improve institutional systems.



# THANK YOU

## End of Session 1

This module concludes Session 1.  
Session 2 will focus on gap analysis & review.



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